

Add Health Recall Bias Validation — Tables

2026-05-01

Data and Measures

Sample. Wave 1 in-home interview ($N = 6,504$) linked to Wave 3 in-home interview via respondent ID (AID). Inner join on AID yields $N = 4,882$ respondents present at both waves; 1,622 Wave 1 respondents are lost to attrition by Wave 3. All Wave 3 respondents matched exactly to Wave 1.

Variables.

Variable	Wave	Label	Role
PA22	W1	Parent self-reported religion	Ground truth for childhood religious environment
H1RE1	W1	Respondent current religion	Adolescent religious identity (~age 16)
H3RE1	W3	Respondent current religion	Adult religious identity (~age 22–26)
H3RE26	W3	Religion raised in	Retrospective recall of childhood religion

Category scheme. A common 5-category scheme is constructed for comparability across waves.

Code	Category	Wave 1 mapping	Wave 3 mapping
0	None	Code 0	Code 0
1	Protestant	Codes 1–19, 27 (incl. JW, LDS, Christian Science, Unitarian)	Codes 1, 8
2	Catholic	Code 22	Code 2
3	Jewish	Code 26	Code 3
4	Other	Codes 20, 21, 23–25, 28	Codes 4–7

Refused, don't know, and not applicable codes are set to NA. Buddhist, Hindu, and Muslim respondents are collapsed into Other due to thin cell counts.

Table 1. Child's own religion at Wave 1 (H1RE1) by PA22 missingness.

Child religion (W1)	PA22 (n)	observed (%)	PA22 missing (n)	observed (%)
None	456	10.7	84	13.7
Protestant	2,598	60.9	367	59.7
Catholic	939	22.0	109	17.7
Jewish	42	1.0	4	0.7
Other	153	3.6	41	6.7
Missing	79	1.9	10	1.6

Table 2. Child-parent religious discordance at Wave 1. Complete cases ($N = 4,188$).

Parental religion (PA22)	<i>n</i>	Discordance rate
None	265	0.434
Protestant	2,709	0.137
Catholic	1,042	0.211
Jewish	48	0.208
Other	124	0.573
Overall	4,188	0.188

Table 3. Child-parent religion cross-tabulation at Wave 1 (raw counts; rows = PA22, cols = H1RE1).

	None	Protestant	Catholic	Jewish	Other
None	150	84	19	1	11
Protestant	215	2,339	84	1	70
Catholic	70	131	822	2	17
Jewish	2	4	2	38	2
Other	19	40	12	0	53

Table 4. Retrospective recall (H3RE26) by actual parental religion (PA22). Row proportions; diagonal in **bold**. Overall mismatch rate = 0.253. Complete cases ($N = 4, 209$).

	Recalled: None	Recalled: Protes- tant	Recalled: Catholic	Recalled: Jewish	Recalled: Other	Mismatch rate
PA22: None	0.508	0.265	0.125	0.004	0.098	0.492
PA22: Protes- tant	0.087	0.742	0.066	0.002	0.103	0.258
PA22: Catholic	0.062	0.053	0.877	0.000	0.009	0.123
PA22: Jewish	0.041	0.082	0.041	0.816	0.020	0.184
PA22: Other	0.137	0.476	0.137	0.008	0.242	0.758

Table 4a. Retrospective recall (H3RE26) by actual parental religion (PA22) – **concordant-at-Wave-1 subsample**. Restricted to respondents whose own Wave 1 religion (H1RE1) matched their parent’s religion (PA22); $N = 3, 364$. In these households there is no ambiguity about the childhood religious environment, so off-diagonal cells more cleanly reflect recall error. Overall mismatch rate = 0.179 (vs. 0.253 in the full sample). Row proportions; diagonal in **bold**.

	Recalled: None	Recalled: Protes- tant	Recalled: Catholic	Recalled: Jewish	Recalled: Other	Mismatch rate
PA22: None	0.642	0.169	0.095	0.000	0.095	0.358
PA22: Protes- tant	0.057	0.792	0.042	0.002	0.107	0.208
PA22: Catholic	0.017	0.030	0.950	0.000	0.004	0.050
PA22: Jewish	0.000	0.000	0.000	0.974	0.026	0.026
PA22: Other	0.057	0.396	0.038	0.019	0.491	0.509

Note. Catholic and Jewish diagonal entries improve substantially relative to Table 4 (0.877 $\rightarrow$ 0.950; 0.816 $\rightarrow$ 0.974), consistent with prior household discordance inflating apparent recall error in the full sample. The None and Other categories show persistent high mismatch even in this clean subsample.

Table 5. Mismatch type by adult religion at Wave 3 (H3RE1). Row percentages. Complete cases ($N = 3,812$).

Adult religion (W3)	Concordant	More secular	More religious	Different religion
None	52.3	31.5	4.3	11.8
Protestant	87.7	1.7	2.5	8.1
Catholic	83.6	1.2	2.2	12.9
Jewish	86.1	2.8	2.8	8.3
Other	31.4	4.1	4.6	60.0

Table 6. Logistic regression: $P(\text{recalled more secular}) \sim \text{adult religion} + \text{parental religion} (+ \text{adolescent religion})$. Outcome: recalled None when PA22 $\neq$ None. Protestant reference throughout. $N = 3,836$.

	Model 1		Model 2	
Term	OR	95% CI	OR	95% CI
<i>Adult religion (ref: Protestant)</i>				
None	38.85***	[26.41, 57.15]	31.28***	[21.04, 46.50]
Catholic	0.79	[0.36, 1.73]	1.17	[0.53, 2.62]
Jewish	5.39	[0.49, 58.93]	4.51	[0.36, 56.01]
Other	2.27*	[1.18, 4.37]	2.23*	[1.16, 4.31]
<i>Parental religion (ref: Protestant)</i>				
Catholic	0.73	[0.51, 1.04]	1.15	[0.73, 1.82]
Jewish	0.24	[0.04, 1.37]	0.21	[0.02, 2.27]
Other	1.46	[0.76, 2.81]	1.21	[0.58, 2.49]
<i>Adolescent religion at W1 (ref: Protestant)</i>				
None			3.25***	[2.27, 4.65]
Catholic			0.30***	[0.17, 0.56]
Jewish			1.60	[0.14, 18.47]

	Model 1	Model 2
Other		1.21 [0.61, 2.38]

* $p < .05$; *** $p < .001$